

Dan HEMSLEY

Senior Product Designer



CONTACT

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SKILLS

- Product Design
- Product Discovery
- Product Strategy
- User Research
- Data-informed Design
- User Experience (UX)
- User Interface (UI)
- Design Systems
- Interaction Design
- Wireframing & Prototyping
- Cross-functional Collaboration
- Agile Product Development
- Front-end Development
- Figma
- Accessibility
- Typography

INTERESTS

- Illustration
- Running & Swimming
- Cooking
- Personal Development
- Family Life

EDUCATION

© BACHELOR OF ARTS (BA)

University of Southampton
Fine Art Painting
2002 - 2005

PROFILE

Senior Product Designer with 12+ years' experience designing and delivering digital products across SaaS, publishing and technology startups. Experienced owning products from discovery through to delivery, combining customer insight, UX strategy, interaction design and front-end expertise to create intuitive, scalable experiences.

I work closely with Product, Engineering and stakeholders to bring clarity to ambiguous problems, challenge assumptions and turn customer and business needs into products that deliver measurable value. My technical background enables me to bridge the gap between design and engineering, from shaping early ideas and rapid prototypes through to scalable design systems and implementation.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

© SENIOR PRODUCT DESIGNER | JUL.2022 - PRESENT

UPDATE

Own end-to-end product design across multiple work-streams, partnering closely with founders, Product and Engineering to shape ideas, validate requirements and take customer-focused solutions from discovery through to delivery.

- Successfully brought two products to market, spanning sales management, hire contracts, resource scheduling, invoice management and jobs boards.
- Improved user satisfaction by 83% on average across multiple product releases.
- Led UX and UI design across multiple product initiatives, translating customer and business needs into intuitive, scalable experiences.
- Designed and implemented a scalable Figma-based design system, improving consistency and collaboration while reducing the design and QA process by 1-2 days per release.
- Contributed directly to the Flutter codebase to ensure accurate implementation of design components and maintain long-term product quality.
- Embedded user-centred design practices throughout the product lifecycle, balancing customer needs with commercial objectives.

◎ ARTIST ILLUSTRATOR | JUL.2021 - JUL.2022

SELF-EMPLOYED

Built an independent creative business focused on illustration, digital content and online community building.

- Built a personal creative brand across social platforms.
- Grew an online audience to more than 100,000 followers through content strategy and live streaming.
- Collaborated with the TikTok UK Creator team to trial new platform features.
- Developed valuable insight into creator tools, digital communities and user engagement from the perspective of both customer and product user.

◎ USER EXPERIENCE DESIGNER | MAR.2019 - JUL.2021

SIXPORTS

Worked closely with clients and stakeholders to define product direction and improve user experience across a suite of digital products.

- Unified multiple products into a single UX strategy, improving customer satisfaction and creating a more consistent product experience.
- Produced early product concepts and interactive prototypes that accelerated stakeholder decision-making.
- Validated requirements directly with clients, reducing friction throughout the design and development process.
- Conducted user research and market analysis to identify opportunities and inform product decisions.

◎ FRONT-END DEVELOPER | JUL.2017 - FEB.2019

MCMNET

Delivered responsive web products while improving collaboration between design and development teams.

- Delivered multiple small to medium-sized websites for clients across a range of industries.
- Introduced development processes that reduced delivery time for common website requirements by 50%.
- Embedded user-centred design practices into development workflows, improving product quality and customer satisfaction.
- Standardised components and templates, reducing design-to-development handover time and improving project consistency.

◎ DESIGNER/FRONT-END DEVELOPER | AUG.2012 - JUN.2017

PUGPIG

Contributed to the design and development of digital publishing products used by global media organisations.

- Collaborated within a multidisciplinary team of 10–15 developers, delivering hundreds of digital publishing titles for multiple publishers.
- Unified the front-end design strategy, achieving full customer adoption, significantly reducing turnaround time for new customer onboarding.
- Led the company's visual identity across two rebrands, including website design and development and marketing materials.
- Created wellbeing initiatives and championed mental health awareness within the company.

◎ GRAPHIC DESIGNER/PRODUCT DESIGN | NOV.2007 - JUL.2012

CALVERLEY

Delivered creative solutions across print and digital media.

- Developed internal tools that reduced response times for client enquiries by 65%.
- Established a new animation service that generated an additional sustained revenue stream for the business.